

Slow-Roasted Pork Shoulder (Variation 8)

Tags: pork, dinner, sunday-roast, gluten-free, low-carb | Prep: 20 min | Cook: 360 min | Serves: 8

Ingredients

- 2.5 kg bone-in pork shoulder, skin on
- 1 tbsp fine salt
- 1 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp fennel seeds, toasted and crushed
- 1 tsp chilli flakes
- 5 garlic cloves, minced
- Zest of 1 orange
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 500 ml dry cider or white wine
- 500 ml chicken stock

Method

1. Score the pork skin in a crosshatch pattern, cutting through the fat but not into the meat.
2. Mix salt, pepper, fennel, chilli, garlic, and orange zest into a paste with olive oil.
3. Rub the paste all over the flesh side of the pork (not the skin). Refrigerate uncovered for 12–24 hours.
4. Preheat oven to 220 °C. Pat skin very dry and rub with extra salt.
5. Place pork skin-side up in a roasting tray. Roast at 220 °C for 30 minutes until skin blisters.
6. Pour cider and stock around the pork. Reduce oven to 150 °C.
7. Roast for 4.5–5 hours until the meat is completely tender and falling off the bone.
8. Rest for 30 minutes before pulling the meat apart with two forks.
9. Remove crackling, break into pieces, and serve alongside the pulled pork.

Chef Tips

- Air-drying the skin uncovered overnight is the best way to ensure crackling — even one hour helps.
- If skin is not crackled after the initial 30 minutes, increase heat to 240 °C for an additional 15 minutes.
- Pulled pork is excellent in tacos, sandwiches, or bowls with pickled vegetables and slaw.